Time Flies

By David Ives

MAY: Well here we are. This is my place.

HORACE: Already? That was fast.

MAY: Swell party, huh.

HORACE: Yeah. Quite a swarm.

MAY: Thank you for flying me home.

HORACE: No. Sure. I'm happy to. Absolutely. My pleasure. I mean-you're very, very, very welcome. *Their eyes lock and they near each other as if for a kiss, their wings fluttering a little. Before their jaws can meet HORACE breaks away.*

HORACE: Anyway, it was very nice meeting you-I'm sorry, is it April?

MAY: May.

HORACE: May Yes. Later than I thought, huh. *They laugh politely.*

MAY: That's very funny, Vergil.

HORACE: It's Horace actually.

MAY: I'm sorry. The buzz at that party was so loud.

HORACE: So you're "May, the mayfly."

MAY: Yeah. Guess my parents didn't have much imagination. May -- mayfly.

HORACE: You don't, ah, live with your parents, do you, May?

MAY: No, my parents died around dawn this morning.

HORACE: Isn't that funny. Mine died around dawn too.

MAY: Maybe it's fate.

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INTRODUCTION

Actor:	*May is the most gorgeous insect on the planet and I'm . . . . I'm with her. Whoo Whoo !*
Actress:	*I have to admit, there's something about Horace . . . . even though we've just met, it seems like we've known each other half our lives! He may be THE ONE!*
Actor:	*Can't seem too eager though . . . courtship is everything . . . but I know she likes me. I can hear it in her Buzzzzzz*
Actress:	*Enough daydreaming . . . It's getting late . . .*
Together:	*Time Flies by David Ives*

MAY: Do you want a drink?

HORACE: I'd love a drink, actually. . .

MAY: Let me just turn on a couple of fireflies. *(May tickles the underside of a couple of TWO-FOOT-LONG FIREFLIES hanging like a chandelier, and the fireflies light up.)*

HORACE: Wow. Great pond! I love the lily pad.

MAY: Care for some music? I've got The Beatles, The Byrds, The Crickets. . .

HORACE: I love the Crickets.

MAY: Well so do I . . . *(She kicks a large, insect-shaped coffee table, and we hear the buzz of crickets.)*

HORACE: *(as they boogie to that)* So are you going out with any-I mean, are there any other mayflies in the neighborhood?

MAY: No, it's mostly wasps.

HORACE: So, you live here by your, um, all by yourself? Alone?

MAY: All by my lonesome.

HORACE: And will you look at that moon.

MAY: You know that's the first moon I've ever seen?

HORACE: That's the first moon I've ever seen. . . !

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MAY: Isn't that funny.

HORACE: When were you born?

MAY: About seven-thirty this morning.

HORACE: So was I! Seven thirty-three!

MAY: Isn't that funny.

HORACE: Or maybe it's fate. *They near each other again, as if for a kiss.* Bzzzzzzz . .

MAY: Bzzzzzzzzz... I think that moon is having a very emotional effect on me.

HORACE: Me too.

MAY: It must be nature. Bzzzzzzzzzz...

HORACE: Bzzzzzzzzzzzzzzz... *They draw their tails very close. Suddenly: A FROG: (amplified, over loudspeaker)* Ribbit, ribbit!

HORACE: &: MAY: The frogs are coming, the frogs are coming! *(They "fly" around the stage in a panic. Ad lib:)* The frogs are coming, the frogs are coming! *(They finally stop, breathless.)*

MAY: It's okay. It's okay.

HORACE: Oh my goodness.

MAY: I think he's gone now.

HORACE: Oh my goodness, that scared me.

MAY: That is the only drawback to living here. The frogs.

HORACE: You know, I like frog films and frog literature. I just don't like frogs.

MAY: Do you want to watch some tube?

HORACE: Sure. What's on?

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MAY: Let's see. *(She checks a TV Guide.)* There is . . . "The Love Bug." "M. Butterfly." "The Spider's Stratagem." "Travels With My Ant." "Angels and Insects." "The Fly. . ."

HORACE: Eugh. Too gruesome.

MAY: "Born Yesterday." And "Life on Earth."

HORACE: What's on that?

MAY: "Swamp Life," with Sir David Attenborough.

HORACE: That sounds good. *May presses a remote control and DAVID ATTENBOROUGH appears, wearing a safari jacket.*

DAVID: Hello, I'm David Attenborough. Welcome to "Swamp Life." You may not believe it, but within this seemingly lifeless puddle, there thrives a teeming world of vibrant life.

HORACE: May, look-isn't that your pond?

MAY: I think that is my pond!

HORACE: He said "puddle."

DAVID: This puddle is only several inches across, but its stagnant water plays host to over fourteen gazillion different species.

MAY: It is my pond!

DAVID: Every species here is engaged in a constant, desperate battle for survival. Feeding-meeting-mating-breeding-dying. And mating. And meeting. And mating. And feeding. And dying. Mating. Mating. Meeting. Breeding. Brooding. Braiding--those that can braid. Feeding. Mating. . .

HORACE: Only one thing on his mind.

MAY: The filth on television these days.

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DAVID: Tonight we start off with one of the saddest creatures of this environment.

HORACE: The dung beetle.

MAY: The toad.

DAVID: The lowly mayfly.

HORACE: Did he say "the mayfly "?

MAY: I think he said "the lowly mayfly."

DAVID: Yes. The lowly mayfly. Like these two mayflies, for instance.

HORACE: May - I think that's us!

MAY: Oh my God...

HORACE: &: **MAY:** We're on television!

HORACE: I don't believe it!

MAY: I can't look at this.

DAVID: As you can see, the lowly mayfly is not one of nature's most attractive creatures.

MAY: At least we don't wear safari jackets.

HORACE: I wish he'd stop saying "lowly mayfly."

MAY: Can I offer you some food? I've got some plankton in the pond. And some very nice gnat.

HORACE: I do love good gnat.

DAVID: The lowly mayfly first appeared some 350 million years ago. . . and is of the order Ephemeroptera, meaning, "living for a single day."

MAY: I did not know that!

HORACE: "Living for a single day." Huh. . .

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MAY: *(setting out a tray on the coffee table)* There you go. There's curried gnat, salted gnat, Scottish smoked gnat. . . gnat with pesto, gnat au naturelle, and Gnat King Cole.

DAVID: Mayflies are a major food source for trout and salmon . . And then there is the giant bullfrog. *FROG: (amplified, over loudspeaker)* Ribbit, ribbit!

HORACE: &: **MAY:** The frogs are coming, the frogs are coming! *They "fly" around the stage in a panic-and end up 'Flying" right into each other's arms.*

HORACE: Well. there.

MAY: Hello.

MAY: *(hypnotized by Horace)* Funny how we flew right into each other's wings.

HORACE: It is funny.

MAY: Or fate.Bzzzz . . .

HORACE: Bzzzzz . . .

DAVID: As you see, mayflies can be quite affectionate. . . . mutually palpating their proboscises.

HORACE: You know, I've been wanting to palpate your proboscis all evening.

MAY: I think it was larva at first sight.

HORACE & **MAY:** *(rubbing proboscises together)* Zzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzzz

DAVID: Unfortunately for this insect, the mayfly has a life span of only one day-living just long enough to meet, mate, have offspring, and die.

MAY: Did he say "meet, mate, have offspring, and DIE"-?

DAVID: In fact, mayflies born at seven-thirty in the morning will die by the next dawn.

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HORACE: &: **MAY:** We're going to die . . . We're going to die! Mayday, Mayday! We're going to die, we're going to die! Weeping and wailing, they kneel, beat their breasts, cross themselves, and tear their hair.

HORACE: What time is it? What time is it?

MAY: I don't wear a watch. I'm a lowly mayfly!

HORACE: *(weeping)* Wah-ha-ha-ha! *(gasping for breath)* Oh my goodness. I think I'm having an asthma attack. Can mayflies have asthma?

MAY: I don't know. Ask Mr. Safari Jacket.

HORACE: Maybe if I put a paper bag over my head. . . Do you have a paper bag?

MAY: I don't have time to look for a paper bag, I'm going to be dead very shortly, all right?

HORACE: *(suddenly sober)* This explains everything. We were born this morning, we hit puberty in mid-afternoon, our biological clocks went BONG, and here we are. Hot to copulate.

MAY: For the one brief miserable time we get to do it.

HORACE: Yeah.

MAY: Breeding. Dying. Breeding. Dying. So this is the whole purpose of mayflies? To make more mayflies?

HORACE: Does the world need more mayflies?

MAY: We're a major food source for trout and salmon.

HORACE: How nice for the salmon.

MAY: Oh Horace, I had such plans. I had such wonderful plans. I wanted to see Paris. I was just hoping to live till Tuesday.

HORACE: What's a Tuesday?

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MAY: The sun's going to be up soon. I'm scared, Horace. I'm so scared.

HORACE: You know, May, we don't have much time, and really, we hardly know each other-but I'm going to say it. I think you're swell. I think you're divine. From your buggy eyes to the thick raspy hair on your legs to the intoxicating scent of your secretions.

MAY: Eeeuw.

HORACE: Eeeuw? No. I say woof. And I say who cares if life is a swamp and we're just a couple of small bugs in a very small pond. I say live, May! I say. . . damn it . . . live!

MAY: But how?

HORACE: Well, I don't honestly know that. . .

MAY: We could fly to Paris!

HORACE: Do we have time to fly to Paris?

MAY: Carpe diem!

HORACE: What is carpe diem?

MAY: It means "bon voyage."

HORACE: And we're outta here! *They fly off to Paris as . . . BLACKOUT.*

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